



1850-64

TAIPING REBELLION

Under the leadership of Hong Xiuquan, the Taiping rebels raged across 16 provinces in their quest to bring down China's Qing rulers. In 1853, Nanjing became capital of their Heavenly Kingdom, a utopian social experiment that promoted the equality of men and women. From 1856, the Qing army under Zeng Guofan began retaking Taiping-held areas, finally capturing Nanjing in 1864 and ending a conflict in which over 20 million died.

◁ Taiping Rebellion

1850

1851 US Congress passes
the Indian Appropriations Act
that confines Indigenous Americans
to reservations

▽ Crystal Palace in London's Hyde Park

1851

GREAT EXHIBITION IN LONDON

Great Britain held the Great Exhibition of the Works of Industry of All Nations in the Crystal Palace - a vast hall made of glass and iron sited in London's Hyde Park. There were 100,000 objects from 15,000 exhibitors, half of them British. Around six million people came to see items including the Koh-i-Noor diamond, Samuel Colt's pistols, Axminster carpets, and precision machinery.



London's Crystal Palace had 293,655 panes of glass